Fall Back! Daylight Saving Time Ends on November 1

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Get ready to fall back! On November 1, 2026, many North Americans will turn their clocks back one hour, adding 60 minutes to their weekend. That simple action marks the end of **Daylight Saving Time** (DST), which began on March 8, 2026. The change shifts more sunlight back into the morning, making it a little easier to wake up for school or work during the shorter winter days ahead.

DST was first introduced during World War I. In 1916, the German Empire moved clocks forward by one hour to reduce the need for artificial lighting and save fuel for the war effort, and the US and Britain soon followed. After the war, the countries returned to **standard time**, then reinstated DST during World War II.

When the war ended in 1945, US officials canceled DST nationwide but allowed states and districts to keep it, each with its own dates. The result was a confusing **patchwork** - by 1965, Iowa alone had 23 different sets of DST dates! The Uniform Time Act of 1966 ended the confusion by setting the same "spring forward" and "fall back" dates for the entire country, but the law was not **mandatory**, so Hawaii, most of Arizona and several US territories chose not to take part.

The dates have moved since then. In 1986, President Ronald Reagan shifted the start to the first Sunday in April, and the Energy Policy Act of 2005 moved it to the second Sunday in March and extended the end to the first Sunday in November, a schedule used since 2007. About 70 countries around the world observe DST, though experts say the twice-a-year changes can disrupt the body's sleep-wake cycle, leading to **fatigue** and reduced concentration.

Several US states have passed laws to stay on DST year-round, but those laws cannot take effect unless federal law changes. The House passed the Sunshine Protection Act, which would make DST permanent nationwide, by a vote of 308-117 in July 2026, but the Senate has yet to approve it. So for now, unless you live somewhere that skips DST, enjoy the bonus hour on November 1!

Word Treasure

Daylight Saving Time -- Daylight Saving Time is the period when clocks are set one hour ahead of standard time.

standard time -- Standard time is the normal local time used when Daylight Saving Time is not in effect.

patchwork -- A patchwork here means a confusing mix of different rules in different places.

mandatory -- Mandatory means something must be done because a rule or law requires it.

fatigue -- Fatigue is a feeling of being very tired and low in energy.

Background you need

Daylight Saving Time is a system that moves clocks forward in spring and back in autumn to shift daylight between morning and evening.

It began as a way to save fuel by reducing the need for artificial lighting during wartime.

Because time rules affect school, work and travel, a whole country needs shared dates instead of many different local ones.

Some places choose not to observe Daylight Saving Time, and changing the national rule requires a change in federal law.

Break it down

LEAD: Clocks go back one hour as Daylight Saving Time ends
KEY EVENT: The fall-back change happens on November 1, 2026
+- ORIGIN: Introduced in World War I to save fuel, then brought back in World War II
+- FIX: The Uniform Time Act of 1966 set shared national dates after years of confusion
EVIDENCE: About 70 countries observe DST, while Hawaii, most of Arizona and several US territories do not take part
OPEN QUESTION: Will the Senate approve making DST permanent nationwide?

Why it matters

Clock changes affect sleep, school and travel for millions of people twice a year. The debate over keeping one time all year is still unresolved because state laws cannot take effect unless federal law changes.

Test what you remember

1. On what date does Daylight Saving Time end in 2026?

- (A) July 2026
- (B) The first Sunday in April
- (C) November 1, 2026
- (D) March 8, 2026

2. How far back do the clocks move?

- (A) One hour
- (B) Two hours
- (C) They do not move
- (D) 30 minutes

3. Why was DST first introduced in 1916?

- (A) To help farmers harvest crops
- (B) To fix a confusing patchwork of dates
- (C) To make evenings darker
- (D) To reduce artificial lighting and save fuel for the war effort

4. What was confusing about DST in Iowa by 1965?

- (A) Iowa never changed its clocks
- (B) Iowa had 23 different sets of DST dates
- (C) Iowa ended DST in winter
- (D) Iowa used two time zones

5. Which places chose not to take part under the Uniform Time Act?

- (A) Hawaii, most of Arizona and several US territories
- (B) Only New York
- (C) Britain and Germany
- (D) Every US state

6. What has happened to the Sunshine Protection Act?

- (A) The Senate approved it first
- (B) It was rejected by the House
- (C) It became law in 2007
- (D) The House passed it by 308-117, but the Senate has yet to approve it

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: A 3: D 4: B 5: A 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Experts cited in the story: Experts say the twice-a-year changes can disrupt the body's sleep-wake cycle, leading to fatigue and reduced concentration.

2. Several US states: Several states have passed laws to stay on DST year-round, but those laws cannot take effect unless federal law changes.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):